Men's Golf Association

MGA BYLAWS

Men's Golf Association

Sky Meadow Country Club

Adopted: _____ Revised: _____

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Men's Golf Association

ARTICLE I — NAME AND PURPOSE

Section 1. ***Name.*** This organization shall be known as the Sky Meadow Country Club Men's Golf Association, hereinafter referred to as the 'Association' or 'MGA.'

Section 2. ***Purpose.*** The purpose of the Association shall be to:

- Promote the game of golf and fellowship among male members of Sky Meadow Country Club.
- Organize and conduct golf tournaments, events, and competitions throughout the season.
- Maintain equitable handicaps in accordance with the World Handicap System (WHS).
- Establish and uphold the Rules of Golf as promulgated by the USGA and R&A.
- Foster sportsmanship, integrity, and camaraderie among all members.

ARTICLE II — MEMBERSHIP

Section 1. ***Eligibility.*** Membership in the Association shall be open to all male members in good standing of Sky Meadow Country Club who hold a Full Golf membership, Junior Executive membership, or equivalent golf-playing membership category as defined by the Club.

Section 2. ***Application.*** Membership in the Association is automatic upon joining Sky Meadow Country Club in an eligible membership category, subject to payment of annual MGA dues. Members may formally register by completing the MGA registration form and submitting dues to the Treasurer prior to the first event of the season.

Section 3. ***Dues.*** Annual dues shall be established by the Board of Directors prior to the commencement of each golf season. Dues shall be used to defray the costs of events, prizes, administration, and other Association activities. Members whose dues are not current shall not be permitted to participate in MGA events until dues are paid.

Section 4. ***Honorary Membership.*** The Board of Directors may, by majority vote, confer Honorary Membership upon individuals who have rendered distinguished service to the Association or to the game of golf. Honorary members shall not be required to pay dues and shall not hold voting rights.

Section 5. ***Good Standing.*** A member in good standing is defined as one whose annual dues are current, who is a member in good standing of Sky Meadow Country Club, and who has not been subject to disciplinary action resulting in suspension or expulsion.

Section 6. ***Resignation.*** Any member may resign from the Association by providing written notice to the Secretary. Resignation does not entitle a member to a refund of dues already paid.

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ARTICLE III — OFFICERS

Section 1. ***Voting Officers.*** The voting officers of the Association shall be:

- Immediate Past President
- President
- Vice President
- Secretary
- Treasurer

Section 2. ***Non-Voting Officers.*** The following shall serve as non-voting officers of the Association, participating in all Board deliberations in an advisory capacity:

- Handicap Committee Chairman
- Chairman of Events

Section 3. ***Advisory Role.*** The Immediate Past President shall serve as an unelected officer of the Association, providing continuity, mentorship, and counsel to the Board of Directors. The Immediate Past President shall hold this role for one (1) year following the conclusion of his term as President.

Section 4. ***Eligibility.*** Any member in good standing of the Association who has been a member for at least one (1) full season shall be eligible to hold office, except for the office of President, which requires at least two (2) years of membership in the Association.

Section 5. ***Election.*** Voting officers shall be elected by a majority vote of members present at the Annual Meeting. Elections shall be held annually. Officers shall take office at the conclusion of the Annual Meeting and shall serve for a term of one (1) year or until their successors are duly elected and installed. Non-voting officers shall be appointed by the President.

Section 6. ***Term Limits.*** No officer shall serve more than three (3) consecutive terms in the same office. After a hiatus of at least one (1) year, a former officer is again eligible for election or appointment to the same position.

Section 7. ***Vacancies.*** In the event a vacancy occurs in any office, the President shall appoint a member in good standing to fill the unexpired term until the next election or, for non-voting officers, until a new appointment is made.

Section 8. ***Removal.*** Any officer may be removed from office for cause by a two-thirds (2/3) vote of the voting officers of the Board, provided that the officer in question has been given reasonable notice and an opportunity to be heard before the Board.

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ARTICLE IV — DUTIES OF OFFICERS

Section 1. ***President.*** The President shall preside at all meetings of the Association and the Board of Directors, serve as the primary spokesperson and representative of the Association, appoint non-voting officers and committee chairpersons as needed, enforce the Bylaws, and perform all other duties incident to the office of President.

Section 2. ***Vice President.*** The Vice President shall assist the President in the discharge of duties, assume the duties of the President in the President's absence or inability to serve, oversee member relations and communications, and perform such other duties as may be assigned by the President or Board.

Section 3. ***Secretary.*** The Secretary shall keep accurate minutes of all meetings of the Association and the Board of Directors, maintain all official records and correspondence, provide required notices to members, maintain the official membership roster, and perform all other duties incident to the office of Secretary.

Section 4. ***Treasurer.*** The Treasurer shall have custody of all Association funds, maintain accurate financial records, collect dues and event fees, pay all authorized expenditures, present a financial report at each Board meeting and at the Annual Meeting, and perform all other duties incident to the office of Treasurer. The Treasurer shall be bonded if required by the Board.

Section 5. ***Handicap Committee Chairman.*** The Handicap Committee Chairman shall oversee the administration of the World Handicap System for all Association members, ensure that scores are properly posted and maintained, resolve handicap questions or disputes in accordance with WHS guidelines, and liaise with the Club's golf professional staff on handicap matters. The Handicap Committee Chairman serves in a non-voting advisory capacity on the Board.

Section 6. ***Chairman of Events.*** The Chairman of Events shall plan, coordinate, and administer all Association tournaments and events in conjunction with the Club's Director of Golf and/or his or her appointed delegates. The Chairman of Events shall publish the annual schedule, establish conditions of competition, arrange for prizes and awards, and submit a post-season report to the Board. The Chairman of Events serves in a non-voting advisory capacity on the Board.

Section 7. ***Immediate Past President.*** The Immediate Past President shall serve in a non-voting advisory capacity to the Board of Directors for one (1) year following his term as President. In this role, he shall provide continuity of institutional knowledge, mentor the incoming President and officers, offer counsel on matters of policy and precedent, and assist with the orientation of newly elected officers. The Immediate Past President shall attend Board meetings and membership meetings as an ex-officio participant.

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ARTICLE V — MEETINGS

Section 1. ***Annual Meeting.*** The Association shall hold an Annual Meeting, typically in the fall following the close of the golf season, for the purpose of electing officers, reviewing the year's activities, presenting financial reports, and transacting any other business properly brought before the membership.

Section 2. ***Opening Night Meeting.*** The Association shall hold an Opening Night Meeting prior to the commencement of each golf season. The purpose of this meeting shall be to welcome members, introduce the year's officers, present the season schedule and conditions of competition, review Association rules and policies, collect dues, and transact any other business appropriate to the start of the season. The date and format of the Opening Night Meeting shall be determined by the Board of Directors.

Section 3. ***Monthly Officers Meetings.*** The Board of Directors shall convene a Monthly Officers Meeting at least once per month during the active golf season. The purpose of these meetings shall be to review ongoing Association business, address operational matters, assess the progress of events, review finances, and prepare for upcoming activities. Monthly Officers Meetings may be conducted in person or by other means of communication as determined by the President.

Section 4. ***Special Meetings.*** Special meetings of the membership may be called by the President or by petition of at least twenty percent (20%) of the members in good standing. Notice of special meetings, including the stated purpose, shall be provided at least ten (10) days in advance.

Section 5. ***Notice.*** Notice of all membership meetings shall be communicated to members at least fourteen (14) days in advance, via email, the Club's communication channels, or such other means as the Board may determine.

Section 6. ***Quorum.*** Twenty percent (20%) of the members in good standing shall constitute a quorum for the transaction of business at any membership meeting.

Section 7. ***Voting.*** Each voting officer and each member in good standing present shall be entitled to one (1) vote on matters brought before the membership. Non-voting officers and the Immediate Past President may participate in discussion but shall not vote. Proxy voting is not permitted. Decisions shall be by majority vote of members present, unless otherwise specified in these Bylaws.

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ARTICLE VI — EVENTS & COMPETITIONS

Section 1. ***Tournament Schedule.*** The Chairman of Events, working in conjunction with the Club's Director of Golf and/or his or her appointed delegates, shall publish an annual schedule of events prior to the start of each golf season. The schedule shall include, at minimum, a season-opening event, a mid-season major, and a season-ending championship. The schedule shall be presented and distributed at the Opening Night Meeting.

Section 2. ***Conditions of Competition.*** The Chairman of Events, in conjunction with the Club's Director of Golf and/or his or her appointed delegates, shall establish and publish the conditions of competition for each event, including the format of play, handicap allowance, and eligibility requirements. All competitions shall be conducted in accordance with the Rules of Golf as established by the USGA and R&A.

Section 3. ***Handicaps.*** MGA events shall use USGA World Handicap System Handicap Indexes as maintained by the Association. The Chairman of Events and Handicap Committee Chairman shall jointly determine handicap allowances appropriate to each format of play.

Section 4. ***Calcutta and Wagering Events.*** The Association may conduct Calcutta auctions or other wagering-related competitions in compliance with applicable Club rules, state law, and the Internal Revenue Code. All such events shall be approved in advance by the Board of Directors.

Section 5. ***Awards and Prizes.*** The Chairman of Events shall arrange appropriate awards and prizes for Association events within the approved budget. All prizes shall conform to applicable USGA amateur status rules. The Association shall maintain a record of all champions, hereinafter the 'Champions Board.'

Section 6. ***Pace of Play.*** All members are expected to maintain an appropriate pace of play during MGA events. The Chairman of Events is authorized to establish and enforce pace of play guidelines, including potential disqualification for excessive delays.

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ARTICLE VII — FINANCES

Section 1. ***Fiscal Year.*** The fiscal year of the Association shall commence on January 1 and end on December 31 of each year, unless otherwise determined by the Board of Directors.

Section 2. ***Budget.*** The Treasurer, in consultation with the Board, shall prepare an annual budget for approval by the Board prior to the start of each season. No expenditures shall be made in excess of approved budget line items without Board approval.

Section 3. ***Financial Review.*** The books and financial records of the Association shall be reviewed annually by a committee of at least two (2) members who are not officers, appointed by the President. A summary of the review shall be presented at the Annual Meeting.

Section 4. ***Signing Authority.*** All checks, drafts, or other orders for payment of money drawn on Association accounts in excess of [AMOUNT] shall require the signature of two (2) authorized officers, as designated by the Board.

Section 5. ***Dissolution.*** In the event of dissolution of the Association, all assets remaining after payment of outstanding obligations shall be donated to a charitable organization selected by the Board of Directors, or as otherwise required by applicable law.

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ARTICLE VIII — CONDUCT & DISCIPLINE

Section 1. ***Code of Conduct.*** All members are expected to conduct themselves in a manner consistent with the Rules of Golf, the rules and policies of Sky Meadow Country Club, and the highest standards of sportsmanship and personal integrity. Conduct unbecoming a member of the Association shall be grounds for disciplinary action.

Section 2. ***Disciplinary Procedure.*** Complaints regarding member conduct shall be submitted in writing to the President. The Board of Directors shall investigate the complaint and provide the accused member with written notice and an opportunity to respond. Possible sanctions include: written warning, suspension from Association activities for a specified period, or expulsion from the Association. Expulsion requires a three-fifths (3/5) vote of the voting members of the Board.

Section 3. ***Appeals.*** A member subject to suspension or expulsion may appeal the Board's decision to a special vote of the membership, provided written notice of appeal is submitted to the Secretary within fifteen (15) days of notification of the Board's decision. The decision of the membership shall be final.

ARTICLE IX — RELATIONSHIP WITH SKY MEADOW COUNTRY CLUB

Section 1. ***Club Affiliation.*** The Association is an affiliated organization of Sky Meadow Country Club. The Association shall operate in compliance with all Club rules, policies, and the terms of any affiliation agreement between the Association and the Club.

Section 2. ***Club Facilities.*** The Association's use of Club facilities, including the golf course, practice areas, and meeting spaces, is subject to the rules and scheduling authority of the Club. The Association shall coordinate with Club management on scheduling of events and use of facilities.

Section 3. ***Non-Liability.*** The Association is an independent voluntary organization. The Club is not responsible for the financial obligations or liabilities of the Association, and the Association is not responsible for the financial obligations or liabilities of the Club.

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ARTICLE X — AMENDMENTS

Section 1. ***Proposal.*** Amendments to these Bylaws may be proposed by any member in good standing or by the Board of Directors. Proposed amendments shall be submitted in writing to the Secretary.

Section 2. ***Notice and Adoption.*** Proposed amendments shall be distributed to all members at least fourteen (14) days prior to the meeting at which the amendment will be considered. Adoption of an amendment requires approval by two-thirds (2/3) of the members present at any duly noticed membership meeting at which a quorum is present.

Section 3. ***Emergency Amendments.*** In matters of emergency, the Board of Directors may adopt temporary rule changes by unanimous vote of the voting officers, effective immediately. Such changes must be ratified by the membership at the next regular membership meeting or they shall lapse.

ARTICLE XI — PARLIAMENTARY AUTHORITY

The rules contained in the current edition of Robert's Rules of Order Newly Revised shall govern the Association in all cases to which they are applicable and in which they are not inconsistent with these Bylaws or any special rules of order adopted by the Association.

ARTICLE XII — EFFECTIVE DATE

These Bylaws shall take effect upon adoption by the membership at a duly noticed meeting at which a quorum is present. All previous bylaws, rules, and regulations of the Association inconsistent herewith are hereby repealed.

CERTIFICATION

We, the undersigned officers of the Sky Meadow Country Club Men's Golf Association, certify that the foregoing Bylaws were duly adopted at a meeting of the membership held on _____.

President	**Vice President**
Secretary	**Treasurer**

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